



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Don't get too close to the river ...



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can write about coincidences and strange events.
- I can write a short narrative.
- I can write about past events.

Ask your partner:

- How often do you read short stories? What kind?
- Do you prefer true stories or fictional stories? Why?





Let's Explore!

It's time to use your imagination. Time to read some **fiction***

* "*Fiction*" means a made-up story that is invented or imagined.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

I have never shared this story with anyone. It has shaken me and left me with nightmares. As I walked home along the bank of Irondale lake, something strange happened. It was after 8 p.m. and I'd had an aggravating day of tests at university. Everything was quiet and there was a full moon high in the evening sky. A party had been organized by my friends at a local pub but I had arrived too late. So, I decided to return home. Along the way, I sat on a park bench near the lake shore and contemplated the beauty of nature. Feeling relaxed, a little tired, I closed my eyes and before too long, I was fast asleep.

When I opened my eyes again, I noticed the weather. Clouds had covered the moon and the night had become cold and dark. I rubbed my eyes to wake up but felt disoriented.

Suddenly, I heard a sound coming from the water. What I saw in the murky water was absolutely horrifying. Slowly, a dark figure began to emerge from the water. I was paralyzed by the shocking sight. The menacing, faceless animal moved closer and started to extend his arms to latch onto my legs.

Then, from out of nowhere, someone appeared on the shore next to me. His clothing was bizarre and he had a deranged look about his face as he shouted, "Get back, beast from the darkness!" With a flash of light, the monster snarled and then vanished slipping under the rippling waters of Irondale lake. The stranger turned to me and barked, "If there is a full moon, never ever fall asleep by the lake." He then stepped forward and whispered, "The Moon Silths will get you." Suddenly, he too vanished in a flash of light leaving me standing at the foot of the lake shore. Shocked and confused I wondered, "What in heaven is a Moon Silth and who was this mysterious stranger who saved me? I stumbled to my feet, glanced at the moon and scurried home ... I have been terrified of the lake ever since.





Let's Practice!

The young man's encounter with the hissing Moon Silth happened in the past.
How does he write about it?

Instructions: Read the sentences below and circle the incorrect words.

1. I have never sharing this story with anyone.
2. It has shaken me and leaving me with nightmares.
3. I stumble to my feet, glanced at the moon and scurry home.
4. With a bright flash, the monster hiss and disappeared under the rippling waters.
5. I was rubbing my eyes to wake up but felt disoriented.
6. I am avoid the river ever since.



Let's Practice!

It's time for you to write a short narrative about a strange event.

Instructions: Write a 120-150 word narrative about a strange event.

The event can be real or fictitious. Include at least two sentences that use the Passive voice. Use the Simple Past tense and the Present Perfect tense to describe past events.

You will need:

- A narrator - the person or "voice" telling the story to a reader
- A setting - specific time and place the story is set
- Characters - the people or animals in a story
- Plot - a series of events that happen in the story - What happens?
- A solution - the end of the plot, how the story finishes





Extension Activity

Does anyone have an interesting story to tell?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Talk to your friends and family about a strange event or coincidence they have experienced.
- Take notes based on the conversation.
- Now, write a 150-170 word short narrative based on the notes you gathered.
- You will need to include:
 - A narrator - the person or "voice" telling the story to a reader
 - A setting - specific time and place the story is set
 - Characters - the people or animals in a story
 - A plot - a series of events that happen in the story - What happens?
 - A solution - the end of the plot, how the story finishes
- Use both the Past tense and Present Perfect tense.
- Proofread your work.
- Read your narrative aloud to your friend or family member.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I discuss a strange event.

☐ ☐

I take notes based on conversations.

☐ ☐

I write a short narrative about a strange event.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to shake** (verb): to cause someone to feel fear, anxiety and shock
e.g. It has shaken me and left me with nightmares.
- pub** (noun): a small restaurant, typical to Great Britain or Ireland, where you can buy drinks and order meals
e.g. A party had been organized by my friends at a local pub but I had arrived too late.
- to contemplate** (verb): to think deeply or carefully about something
e.g. I sat on a park bench near the lake shore and contemplated the beauty of nature.
- disoriented** (adjective): lost or confused
e.g. I rubbed my eyes to wake up but felt disoriented.
- paralyzed** (adjective): unable to do anything out of fear
e.g. I was paralyzed by the shocking sight.
- menacing** (adjective): dangerous or possibly harmful
e.g. The menacing, faceless animal moved closer.
- to latch on** (verb): to grab and hold
e.g. It started to extend his arms to latch onto my legs.
- to scurry** (verb): to move quickly and with short steps
e.g. I stumbled to my feet, glanced at the moon and scurried home.





Learning Points

Writing a Short Narrative

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a finished action or event that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about a finished action or event **not** necessarily connected to the present.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together. There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

To help you decide whether you should use the Present Perfect tense or the Past Simple tense, ask yourself the questions 'When?'

If you can answer the question 'When?', then the past time is stated or inferred or understood. There is no connection to the present.

If the you cannot answer the question 'When?', then the time is not stated or not important and you would choose the Present Perfect tense because there is a connection to the present.

Examples:

- *I have never shared this story with anyone.*
- *It has shaken me and left me with nightmares.*
- *I stumbled to my feet, glanced at the moon and scurried home.*
- *I sat on a park bench near the lake shore and contemplated the beauty of nature.*

